

(e) The gift economy

(10 Marks)

Gift economy was first studied and reported by B. Malinowski (Argonauts of Western Pacific - 1924) and Marsel Mauss (The Gift - 1954).

It refers to the ceremonial exchange of non utilitarian goods among communities without any obligation to return.

① Kula exchange by Frans Boesch (Mwali and Souva)

② Potlatch - first by Pacific tribes

③ Noka ceremony

④ "DAAN" to Brahmins

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Guided by values, customs
societal obligations

CHARACTERISTICS

→ Non monetary, non barter

→ Non participation results in societal exclusion (sanction)

→ can be balanced, generalised, directional reciprocity (As salines)

THINKERS

① Malinowski noted that such exchange is performed in expectation of bigger return

② Mauss called such gifts 'Total prestations' and called them a societies collective representation

③ Karl Polanyi in 'The Great transformation-1944' advanced these findings to put forth Substantivist school of thought

↓
Economy is embedded in
kinship, society etc

↓
western market economy models fail in primitive societies

CONTEMPORARY

Such pure gift economies are on a decline and now monetary expectations are attached to gifts

Still, they provide insight into different societies and help adopt culture relativistic approach.

Marks:

Comment:

Intro:

Body:

Conclusion:

Total:

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